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Menus

Menus have been an inherent part of our computing experience since 1970's when command line interfaces were first introduced. Gradually, as mankind invented numerous different ways of interacting with computing devices, Menus evolved in their design and application, leading to extremely natural and intuitive user experiences. In the following pages, we give you a glimpse of developments and trends in User Interfaces space that will indisputably revolutionize everything we know about UI today

Revolutionizing User Interfaces

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Take a look at your body, your arms, your limbs, your fingers, you'll realise that your body is an amazing device with over

hundreds of degrees of freedom and thus has tons of ways of interacting with objects and devices around it. With computer scientists and user experience designers across the world working on developing all new ways of interaction, you can just wave your hand, blink your eyes, blow air from your mouth, or just think about something to interact with devices. Awesome interfaces shown in movies such as Avatar, Star Trek and Iron Man are slowly becoming a reality. Jinha Lee, a researcher in MIT Media Lab is working on Space Top, a 3D interface very similar to Iron Man's interactive holograms using which you can grab files like real world objects and move them around. Swiss scientists are working on a mind-control system similar to the one shown in the movie

avatar where a human mind can control a robot by just thinking. However, we're jumping ahead. Touch is the UI of choice right now, but is it good enough?

Going beyond touch

Almost every modern-day technology can be traced back to a Research project in some world class University or Research lab. Following that pattern, we can predict the future technologies by understanding



IronMan Lab: The Iron Man Lab

and analyzing the current Research projects. It is also important to note that many of these Research projects do not turn viable for commercial use, but they act as a base for some other technology – Holographic technology, for example. Sure, multi-touch was an innovative way of Interaction – but people are in need of something new due to two reasons:

1. It does have some disadvantages. Touch doesn't provide the freedom that a mouse provides. For example, one cannot hover over a hyperlink on a touch device. It is also difficult to select text by touching, as the text might be smaller in size than the user's finger. So, there is a need for a more flexible Interaction system.
2. People are in need of more natural ways of Interaction. May be more than just using one's finger or a stylus. May be more like how we interact with each other with gestures or signs or voice. This need of new Interaction methods led to: